FAITHFUL PATH COMMUNITY

Pentecostal Dating: A Conversation Worksheet

Pastor Richmond Kobe

Read the full article: faithfulpathcommunity.com/articles/pentecostal-christian-dating

Use this worksheet once you are dating seriously, or thinking about it. Print one copy each. Part 1 is for you alone and stays private unless you choose to share it. In Part 2, write your own answer to each question first, then talk it through together and note what you discussed.

You do not need to settle everything in one evening. Take one section at a time over several weeks. If a difference on one of these questions would be a deal-breaker for either of you, it is kinder to find out early.

Before you begin. Share only what you feel free and safe to share. Either person can skip a question or pause the conversation. You may keep private notes private. If you fear your partner's reaction or experience threats, control or sexual pressure, set aside the joint exercise and seek confidential individual support.

Part 1: For you alone

Answer these honestly before God. This part is private unless you choose to share it.

1. Does this relationship honour Christ? Are we both growing closer to God, or is it crowding Him out?

2. Are we spiritually compatible in essential beliefs: who Jesus is, the authority of Scripture, and the place of the Holy Spirit?

3. Are our physical and emotional boundaries clear, and are we keeping them?

4. Have I seen how this person handles anger, money, family and disappointment over time?

5. Am I listening to parents, pastors and mature friends, while still owning my own decisions before God?

Part 2: Faith and the Holy Spirit

What do each of us believe about God as Father, Son and Holy Spirit? How would those beliefs shape where we worship and what we teach our children?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

☐ We agree ☐ We can work this out ☐ Talk to a pastor ☐ Could be a deal-breaker

What do you believe about baptism in the Holy Spirit and speaking in tongues?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

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What do you believe about healing and the gifts of the Spirit today?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

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Part 2: Church and worship

How central is church attendance to your life?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

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Do you expect your future spouse to join your denomination or congregation?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

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Can we both worship freely in the same church? Which church would we attend together after marriage?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

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What would happen if we could not agree on which church to attend?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

☐ We agree ☐ We can work this out ☐ Talk to a pastor ☐ Could be a deal-breaker

Part 2: Boundaries and standards

What physical boundaries do you expect while we are dating?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

☐ We agree ☐ We can work this out ☐ Talk to a pastor ☐ Could be a deal-breaker

Do our churches expect different things in dress, entertainment or alcohol? What do you expect?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

☐ We agree ☐ We can work this out ☐ Talk to a pastor ☐ Could be a deal-breaker

Part 2: Family, pastors and the future

How involved should our pastors and parents be?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

☐ We agree ☐ We can work this out ☐ Talk to a pastor ☐ Could be a deal-breaker

Would either of our families regard our marriage as spiritually unacceptable?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

☐ We agree ☐ We can work this out ☐ Talk to a pastor ☐ Could be a deal-breaker

What do you believe about the roles of husbands and wives in marriage?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

☐ We agree ☐ We can work this out ☐ Talk to a pastor ☐ Could be a deal-breaker

How would we raise and baptise our children?

My answer

Notes from our conversation

☐ We agree ☐ We can work this out ☐ Talk to a pastor ☐ Could be a deal-breaker

Putting it together

Look back at the questions where you differed. For each difference, ask: is this a **biblical command** (clearly taught in Scripture for all believers), a **biblical wisdom principle** (drawn from Scripture and applied with wisdom), or a **local church custom** (one church's way of applying a principle)? Never treat a church custom as if it were a command of Scripture.

Notice too whether a difference is about **doctrine**, such as what you believe about God or baptism, or about **local custom**, such as dress or chaperones. Differences in doctrine shape where you worship and what you teach your children, so give them more time and talk them through with a pastor.

Where we clearly agree

Differences we can work out, and how

Questions to take to a pastor together

Anything that could be a deal-breaker for either of us

Our next step

Going further. *Before You Say Yes* is Pastor Richmond's practical guide to Christian dating, with red flags, green flags and how to test a claim that "God told me". To talk your relationship through with him, book a conversation through Talk to a Pastor.

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